

Houssem Chammam

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Nationality: Tunisian.

Research profile

Public policy researcher working at the intersection of institutional analysis and digital technologies. Interested in how information flows, organizational structures, and digital platforms influence collective action, institutional performance, and public sector adaptation. Experienced in mixed-methods research, comparative case analysis, and the study of complex socio-technical systems.

Education

2023–Mar. 2026 *Master of Public Policy (MPP)*, Willy Brandt School of Public Policy, University of Erfurt, Germany.

DAAD Helmut Schmidt Scholarship. GPA: 1.5 (German scale).

Concentration: Global Public Policy, Development and Socio-Economic Policies.

Thesis: *The Role of Water in the Energy Transition: Institutional Asymmetries in Tunisia's Water-Energy Nexus*. Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Andreas Goldthau.

2017–2021 *Bachelor of Arts in Political Science/IR*, Carleton College, Minnesota.

The George Foundation Scholarship. GPA: 3.64/4

Concentration: Public Policy Analysis.

Awards: Distinction in the Major; Distinction for Exceptional Research in capstone project.

Professional experience

Aug. 2025–
present

Consultant, North African Policy Initiative (NAPI), Tunis–Hybrid..

Advised the Embassy of the Netherlands in Tunisia on bilateral development opportunities related to the Water–Energy–Food Nexus. Produced a commissioned policy report examining administrative coordination challenges in Tunisia's energy utility.

Conducted commissioned policy research on green bonds in EMEA region for *Facing Finance e.V.*

Dec. 2024– Jun. 2025	<i>Policy Fellow</i>, North African Policy Initiative (NAPI), Tunis–Hybrid. Led the design and rollout of a Mediterranean youth policy-training program. Designed and delivered four training modules on policy analysis, research methods, and stakeholder engagement. Drafted newsletters, social media copy, and program descriptions.
Mar. 2024– Dec. 2024	<i>Research Assistant</i>, German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA), Hamburg. Conducted targeted research and literature reviews, in support of an international research project on political communication in authoritarian regimes. Led the project’s logistical coordination and stakeholder engagement. Organised one international academic conference and three live online events, managing logistics and outreach.
Jun. 2021– Apr. 2023	<i>Public Policy and Public Finance Analyst</i>, Al Bawsala, Tunis. Conducted budgetary data analysis and reviewed finance law provisions to assess expenditure and revenue structures, fiscal incentives, and regional financing dynamics. Co-authored two reports and authored five policy papers on public finance, energy transition, and subsidy reform. Designed and delivered training programs on policy analysis for 20+ NGOs and civil society organizations. Contributed to policy consultations on digitalization, fiscal reform, and public sector governance. Represented the organisation in national media and international forums on debt sustainability and economic policy.
May 2020– Aug. 2020	<i>Public Finance Intern</i>, Institute for Policy Studies (IPS), Washington, D.C. Conducted research on U.S. fiscal policy, development aid spending, and infrastructure investments. Provided policy analysis to support supervisory testimony in the U.S. Senate, contributing to high-level discussions on COVID-19 fiscal responses and federal budget allocations. Produced communication materials including social media posts, newsletter items, and podcasts.

Jan. 2019–
Jun. 2019

Research Project Lead, Department of Political Science, Carleton College, Minnesota..

Initiated and led a comparative media analytics project on media ownership and election coverage under the supervision of Barbara Allen.

Co-developed the research design, coding protocol, and transcript analysis workflow for a 7-student research team.

Built an R-based text-processing script to classify candidate and election references in large media transcript datasets.

Presented findings at two regional conferences, linking comparative results to debates on U.S. media governance.

Skills

Research Methods & Design: Research design and comparative analysis; qualitative and mixed-methods research; literature review and synthesis; policy and institutional analysis; application of the Institutional Analysis and Development (IAD) framework.

Data Collection & Fieldwork: Policy and legal text analysis; interview and survey design; Coding protocols.

Computational Skills: Quantitative analysis using R and Python; text-as-data approaches; data processing and visualization; Excel (advanced); Canva (advanced); Latex (intermediate); Tosmana (beginner).

Thematic Expertise: Public finance and fiscal governance; energy transition and water–energy nexus; digitalization and state capacity; regulatory governance and policy coordination.

Languages

English: Full proficiency. French: Full proficiency. Arabic: Native.
Spanish: Conversational German: Conversational.

Publications

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| 2023 | Chammam, H., & Attia, K. (October 2023). <i>Austerity: Necessity or Avoidable Misery?</i> Al Bawsala & Rosa Luxemburg Stiftung. [Original publication in Arabic.] |
| 2022 | Chammam, H., & Mechmech, S. (November 2022). <i>Austerity: A Chronic Condition of Public Health</i> . Al Bawsala. https://www.albawsala.com/en/publications/20225498 |
| under review | Chammam, H. <i>Institutional Path Dependency and Asymmetric Adaptation in Tunisia's Water-Energy Nexus: An IAD-NAAS Analysis</i> . CIDOB (Barcelona Centre for International Affairs), issue no. 143, "Middle East and North Africa: Facing the Energy Transition Challenge." |